



What is **Navigation**

Key Questions

Users Ask

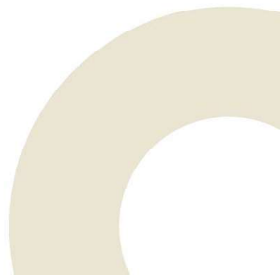
- How is content structured?
- Where am I now?
- Where can I go?
- Where did I come from?
- How do I go back?

Navigation

Purpose

- Promote wayfinding in software
- Define different navigation types
- Guide navigation design
- Apply useful navigation patterns

Best: no navigation needed :)





Signposts & Wayfinding

Signposts

- Features helping users figure out surroundings
- Page/window titles & web-page logos
- Branding devices, tabs & selection indicators
- Global & local navigation links
- Progress indicators & breadcrumbs
- Annotated scroll bars

Wayfinding

- What users do to find their way to goals
- Clear, unambiguous labels at each decision point
- Strong calls to action on first pages
- Environmental clues (X close, logos in corners)
- Maps provide mental picture of whole space
- Some users prefer sign-to-sign; others need overview





Global Navigation

Signposts

- Top navigation (horizontal menu)
- Left sidebar navigation
- Both: inverted L navigation layout
- Menus, tabs, and/or sidebars

Wayfinding

- Bottom of screen, persists across screens
- Internal left-right scroll for extra items
- Hamburger menu (three horizontal lines)
- Three dots menu variant
- Tapping invokes navigation panel

Site or app navigation on every main screen
how users move around the formal navigational structure.

